

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3♥

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Board: 5

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: South

**Board 1**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 4 2  
 ♥ K Q 10  
 ♦ A J 7 5 3  
 ♣ Q 8 7

♠ 7  
 ♥ A J 9 8 7 5 4  
 ♦ 8  
 ♣ K 10 6 3

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ Q J 10  
 ♥ 3  
 ♦ K 10 9 6 2  
 ♣ A J 9 4

♠ A K 9 8 6 5 3  
 ♥ 6 2  
 ♦ Q 4  
 ♣ 5 2

| West | North | East | South |
|------|-------|------|-------|
|      | 3♥    |      |       |

All Pass

3♥ by North

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 1/2 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 4 : Total = 6/7

The ♠ lead is about the best thing that could have happened to you. You win with dummy's ♠A and play ♠K, discarding your ♦. You then lead a small ♣, covering anything West plays. You'd like to ruff a ♣ if you can, but if they play trumps to stop you then you'd like the trump play to come from East. East leads the ♥3, West plays the ♥K, and you win with the ♥A. You play a small ♣. If the defender who wins the ♣ doesn't play another trump then you can ruff your third ♣ in dummy. If the defender **DOES** play a trump, then you lose only one trump trick. You end up going down 1, which is pretty good.

Some contracts are impossible. So you just play to keep the damage as low as possible.

You really really want to say 3♠. Here are three good reasons you shouldn't.

You have 9 ♥s between you. You may have only 7 ♠s. If you bid 3♠ partner may bid again. You haven't been doubled.

South would play 3♥.

Click

North plays 3♥. East leads the ♠Q.

**North plays 3♥. East leads the ♠Q.**

It turns out there was a fourth reason not to bid 3♠ - the opponents might lead the suit.

**Board 3**  
West Deals  
E-W Vul

♠ A 8 2  
♥ K Q 5  
♦ Q J 7 3  
♣ Q 6 4

♠ K 7 4  
♥ 8 7 2  
♦ K 8 2  
♣ J 10 7 5



♠ Q J 10  
♥ A 3  
♦ 10 9 5 4  
♣ A K 3 2

♠ 9 6 5 3  
♥ J 10 9 6 4  
♦ A 6  
♣ 9 8

| West                                                             | North | East | South |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|------|-------|
| 1 ♦                                                              | Pass  | 2NT  | Pass  |
| 3NT                                                              |       |      |       |
| All Pass                                                         |       |      |       |
| 3NT by East                                                      |       |      |       |
| other. While this is a possible Plan, there is a far better one. |       |      |       |

You have three reasonable choices. You could bid 2♣, you could jump to 3♦, or you could jump to 2NT.

While all are reasonable, the jump to 2NT stands out as the most constructive by far. Partner bids 3NT and you pass.

East plays 3NT. South leads the ♥J.

**East plays 3NT. South leads the ♥J.**

Winner count: ♠ 1 : ♥ 3 : ♦ 0 : ♣ 3 : Total = 7

If South has the ♠K then a finesse will gain you the two winners you need. However, if North has the ♠K then the finesse will gain you just one winner and you will be hoping for a 3-3 ♣ split for the

Rather than chance the ♠ finesse, you should immediately start establishing your ♦s. This has the advantage of not giving the defense any **NEW** winners - they were always going to get their two high ♦s. So win the ♥A and play the ♦10. Somebody will take this and probably continue with a ♥. Take the ♥Q and play the ♦Q. Somebody will take this and probably continue with a ♥. Take the ♥K and then the rest of your winners. Maybe the ♣s will split 3-3 and give you an overtrick. And if you have assured the contract you MIGHT even try the ♠ finesse.

If you had taken an early ♠ finesse you would have gone down.

North would have won and played a ♥, removing your second stopper. When ♣s did not split 3-3 you would have been forced to try a ♦. North would win his ♦K and drive out the last ♥ stopper. Then South would be able to take the ♦A plus his established ♥s.

**Board 5**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 10 5 3

♥ 4

♦ K 10 8 3

♣ K 10 2

♠ 8 7

♥ A 8 3

♦ 9 5 2

♣ Q 8 7 4 3



♠ 9 4

♥ 7 6 5 2

♦ Q 7 6 4

♣ A J 9

♠ A K 6 2

♥ K Q J 10 9

♦ A J

♣ 6 5

West

North

East

South

Pass

2♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

but cannot over-ruff. Return to your hand with the ♦ A and ruff your last ♠ with dummy's ♥ A. Return to your hand with a trump. You will lose three minor suit cards and nothing else.

Some would go down on this hand when they ruffed the first ♠ with dummy's ♥ 3 and East over-ruffed. It is pretty clear that you should ruff with one of the higher cards, but sometimes the thought comes too late.

With 19 points and a 5-card ♥ suit you open 1♥.

Partner raises you to 2♥.

Partner's bid shows 6-10 points. If he has 6 it might be close, but otherwise you should have a game. You bid 4♥.

South plays 4♥. West leads the ♠ Q.

**South plays 4♥. West leads the ♠ Q.**

Losers: ♠ 2 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 2 : Total = 5

The three minor suit losers cannot be avoided, but the two ♠ losers can be ruffed in dummy. A small amount of caution is in order. Win the ♠ K and play the ♠ A. Ruff a ♠ with dummy's ♥ 8. East shows out